📘 Case Study : Phishing

Phishing is a type of cybercrime in which attackers deceive individuals into sharing sensitive information such as passwords, bank details, or OTPs by posing as trusted entities. It usually occurs through emails, SMS, or fake websites that closely resemble official platforms.

A typical phishing attack begins when a victim receives a message claiming to be from a bank or service provider, often creating urgency like “Your account will be suspended.” The message includes a link that redirects to a fake website. When the user enters their credentials, the attacker captures the data and may misuse it for unauthorized access or financial transactions.

A real example is the rise in phishing scams reported in India during the COVID-19 period, where fraudsters sent fake emails in the name of banks and government relief schemes. Many people entered their details on fake websites and lost access to their accounts.

Phishing mainly targets students, elderly users, and less tech-aware individuals. The consequences include financial loss, identity theft, and privacy breaches. This can be prevented by verifying links, avoiding suspicious messages, and never sharing confidential information online.